

BUS 313: The Economic and Financial Environment of Global Business

Shidler College of Business, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa
Fall 2025

Instructor: Adam Stauffer

Email: adamstau@hawaii.edu (Please begin subject lines with "BUS 313 [your section]")

Office Hours: By appointment (schedule via email)

Email is the primary communication channel.

Lamaku should be checked regularly (especially the day before class).

Class Time & Location

Section 003: Wed/Fri 9:00 – 10:15 AM, BUSAD C102

Section 004: Wed/Fri 10:30 – 11:55 AM, BUSAD C102

Textbook & Course Materials

Pugel, *International Economics*, 18th edition (McGraw-Hill Education, 2024).

- Access to **McGraw-Hill Connect** (via Lamaku "MH Campus" link).
- Slides and announcements will be posted on **Lamaku** (<https://lamaku.hawaii.edu/portal>).

This course participates in the **Bookstore's Interactive Digital Access Program (IDAP)**.

- Materials are delivered digitally by the first day of class.
 - The IDAP charge will appear on your MyUH account unless you opt out.
 - Opt-out details are provided in the bookstore's IDAP email.
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Course Description & Objectives

This course develops students' understanding of the global economic and financial environment of business. It introduces trade and international finance theory and applies it to real-world case studies across global regions.

Topics include:

- Basic demand and supply analysis in open economies
- Comparative advantage and factor endowments

- Scale economies, imperfect competition, and trade
- Growth and trade
- Tariffs, non-tariff barriers, and protectionism
- Trade blocs and preferential trade agreements
- Trade and the environment
- Multinationals, migration, and international capital flows

By the end of the course, you will be able to apply core trade models to evaluate policies, disputes, and their distributional consequences.

About the Instructor

Adam holds an MBA in Finance from The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania and previously held the Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) designation. He served as Chief Investment Officer at Springline Capital (BVI) and founded Greenshoot.org, a disaster relief technology company. He also worked as a trader and market-maker at Barclays Capital and Lehman Brothers in New York, where his desk managed all U.S.-listed Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs). Before his MBA, Adam was a Marketing Manager at Advent Software specializing in hedge funds and offshore fund administrators.

Grading

Component	Weight
Attendance & Participation	10%
Weekly Homework (MH Connect)	20%
Group Project (Online Retailing)	15%
AI + GitHub Project	5%
Midterm Exam	25%
Final Exam	25%
Total	100%

Grades are rounded up to the nearest whole number. Adjustments are only made for documented scoring errors.

Attendance & Participation

Attendance will be recorded and contributes to your grade.

Homework

- Assigned weekly via **MH Connect**.
 - Due Fridays by midnight.
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Group Project (Online Retailing)

- Teams of 3–4 students.
 - Two short presentations (5 minutes each) in the final weeks of class.
 - Task: Select a product to sell online in the U.S., source from a non-U.S. supplier, and analyze unit economics, competitors, and demand.
 - Grade breakdown: 12.5% presentation, 2.5% peer evaluation.
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AI + GitHub Course Project (Trade & Tariff Case Brief)

This project applies course concepts to a **real-world trade dispute or policy** (tariffs, quotas, or trade agreements). Students will:

- Apply Ricardian, Heckscher-Ohlin, and Specific-Factors models.
- Identify winners/losers across consumers, producers, and governments.
- Evaluate distributional and policy implications.
- Use AI for research, modeling, critique, and visualization.
- Use GitHub for reproducibility (templates, deliverables, prompt logs).

Workflow:

1. **README (Assignment Brief)** – outlines problem and rubric
 2. **Prompts** – AI queries (students adapt/expand but must log)
 3. **Spec** – project plan (models, data, acceptance criteria)
 4. **Analysis & Deliverables** – case brief, tables, figures
 5. **Prompt Log & Reflection** – documentation of AI use
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Examinations

Midterm & Final Exam on MH Connect.

Make-up exams are only considered for legitimate, documented circumstances (serious illness, family emergency). Approval must be obtained in advance.

Course Schedule (subject to change)

Week	Date	BUS 313 Reading	Homework Due (Friday by Midnight)
1	Aug-27	Intros	
	Aug-29	Case Study: Geopolitics - Nations' reaction to climate change, the use force and economics to take control of food/water resources.	
2	Sep-3	Case Study: continued + discussion	
	Sep-5	Ch. 1 International Economics Is Different	Ch. 1
3	Sep-10	Ch. 2 Basic Theory Using Demand and Supply	
	Sep-12	Ch. 3 Why Everybody Trades: Comparative Advantage	Ch. 2, 3
4	Sep-17	Ch. 4 Trade: Factor Availability and Factor Proportions Are Key	
	Sep-19	Ch. 5 Who gains and Who Loses from Trade pages 68-71, 76-84 (optional: case studies pgs 77 & 81)	Ch. 4, 5
5	Sep-24	Ch. 6 Scale Economics, Imperfect Competition, and Trade pages 88-101, 104-105, 108-113	
	Sep-26	Meet with your project team Ice-breakers - Get to know your team	Ch. 6
6	Oct-1	Ch. 7 Growth and Trade Case Study: Cobalt Red & Electronics Trade	
	Oct-3	Ch.8 Analysis of a Tariff pages 137-157 (excluding Extension pg 144-145 & Case Study 154-155)	Ch. 7, 8
7	Oct-8	Ch. 9 Nontariff Barriers to Imports pages 161-190 (excluding Extension 172-174, Case Study 176-177 & Case Study 180-181; optional Focus on China 186-187)	
	Oct-10	Case Study: Tariffs & NTBs Current Events	Ch. 9
8	Oct-15	Practice Exam (OPTIONAL) Opens at class time; closes Thursday at midnight	
	Oct-17	Midterm on MH Connect Opens at class time; closes 24 hours later	
9	Oct-22	Ch. 10 Arguments For and Against Protection pages 193-218 (excluding Focus on Labor + Case Study)	
	Oct-24	Ch. 17 Foreign Exchange Case Study: Russian Sanctions	Ch. 10, 17
10	Oct-29	Ch. 11 Pushing Exports pages 225-246	

	Oct-31	TBD	Ch. 11
11	Nov-5	Ch. 12 Trade Blocs and Trade Blocks pages 254-269; 271-274	
	Nov-7	Meet with your project team - Top 3 product choices submitted in Laulima Assignments by midnight	Ch. 12
12	Nov-12	Ch. 13 Trade and the Environment optional: Global Governance - Dolphins, Turtles and the WTO	
	Nov-14	TBD	Ch. 13
13	Nov-19	Ch. 14 Trade Policies for Developing Countries pages 312-326; 330-331	
	Nov-21	Meet with your project team to finalize Team Presentations - Product choice submitted in Laulima Assignments by midnight	Ch. 14
14	Nov-26	Ch. 15 Multinationals and Migration: International Factor Movements pages 335-345; 348-357 (optional: Focus on China); 360-367	
	Nov-28	TBD	Ch. 15
15	Dec-3	Case Study: AI in the Workplace	
	Dec-5	Meet with your project team to finalize Team Presentations - Product choice submitted in Laulima Assignments by midnight	
16	Dec-10	Group Preso #1: Sales Practice Exam (OPTIONAL) Opens after class time; closes Wed. at midnight	
	Dec-12	Group Preso #2: Unit Economics	
17	Dec-17	Final Examination Period	
	Dec-19		

AI Use Policy (Undergrad Context)

Students are encouraged to explore AI tools to enhance learning and professional decision-making. Acceptable uses include:

- **Knowledge Enhancement:** Use AI to clarify theory or extend readings.
- **Research Support:** Gather data, statistics, and examples for assignments.
- **Critical Thinking:** Test your arguments against counterarguments generated by AI.
- **Problem-Solving:** Simulate case scenarios and brainstorm managerial responses.
- **Professional Skills:** Practice clear, concise communication in prompts and outputs.

Requirements:

- Log all AI use in the Prompt Log.
 - Verify outputs against trusted sources.
 - Treat AI as a supplement — not a substitute — for your own analysis.
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Campus Policies

- **Students with Disabilities:** Contact the KOKUA Program (Student Services Center, Room 13; 956-7511; <http://www.hawaii.edu/kokua/>).
- **Academic Honesty:** UH Mānoa has a zero-tolerance policy for plagiarism or cheating. Definitions and examples are detailed in the UH Student Conduct Code (<http://www.hawaii.edu/student/conduct>).